

Double delight: World No. 23 Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopi Chand took out World No. 10 pair Jongkolphan Kititharakul-Rawinda Prajongjai of Thailand to facilitate India's historic win at the 2024 Badminton Asia Team Championships. GETTY IMAGES



Double(s) whammy for Indian badminton!

Women's doubles pair, Gayatri Gopi Chand and Treesa Jolly, talks about the BATC exploits, how their partnership was formed, their contrasting personalities and more.

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India's victory at the Badminton Asia Team Championships (BATC) was a team effort, but the women's doubles pair of Gayatri Gopi Chand and Treesa Jolly played a significant role. The two 20-year-olds were unbeaten throughout the tournament and won crucial doubles matches against higher-ranked opponents. They helped India secure a 3-2 win against

China in the group stage, defeated a former World number 2 pair in the semifinals against Japan, and secured the championship against a World number 10 pair in the final against Thailand.

Ahead of the European leg of the international badminton circuit, the two spoke to *Sportstar* about how their partnership was formed, how their contrasting personalities complement each other perfectly on the court, their aspirations for the Olympics, and why Treesa is referred

to as the 'Kumbhakaran' of Indian badminton.

Congratulations on your win at the Badminton Asia Team Championships. How did you celebrate the win?

Treesa: We celebrated the win right after the Championships were over. The entire team went for lunch, and we had boba tea. It was a pretty fun evening.

When you go out for lunch, what